L-T-778b
March 22, 1967

SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. L-T-00778a(GSA-FSS)
September 16, 1965

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

TRAY, MESS, COMPARTMENTED, (PLASTIC)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers requirements for six compartmented plastic mess trays for school, hospital, and cafeteria use.

1.2 Classification. The plastic compartmented mess trays covered herein shall be of the following types as specified (see 6.2):

Six compartmented - right handed
10 by 14-1/2 inches (fig. 1).

Six compartmented - left handed
10 by 14 inches (fig. 2).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

L-M-181 - Melamine Molded Plastics.
UU-P-553 - Paper, Wrapping, Tissue.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).
Fed. Std. No. 595 - Colors.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C., 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

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Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following document forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids shall apply.

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and General Regulations Promulgated Thereunder.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C., 20402.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The molding compound used for manufacturing the trays shall conform to type I of L-M-181, except that electrical property requirements under table II shall not apply. The use of any previously cured and reground scrap material in the molding compound is prohibited. When specified (see 6.2), the contractor shall furnish a certificate of compliance to the contracting officer showing that the molding compound used in the manufacture of the trays complies with the requirements of this paragraph. The certificate shall show the actual test values obtained on the material.

3.1.1 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act certification. The molding compound and any substitute incorporated in the plastic shall conform to the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act for contact with food. When specified (see 6.2), the contractor shall furnish a certificate of compliance to the contracting officer showing that the molding compound used in the manufacture of the trays complies with the requirements of this paragraph.

3.2 Design and dimensions. The design and dimensions of trays shall be as shown on figures 1 and 2.

3.3 Construction. Trays shall be molded from molding compound specified in 3.1.

3.4 Color and finish.

3.4.1 Color. The color of trays shall be approximately tan number 13690 of Fed. Std. No. 595.

3.4.2 Finish. The surface of the trays shall have a uniformly high luster throughout, produced by molding. No surface shall be painted or otherwise treated with a protective coating or other adulterant. No machining of surfaces shall be permitted except for removal of flash at dividing line of mold. Flash or parting line after machining shall be burnished.

3.5 Uniformity. All trays shall be uniform in finish, gloss, density, color, and other properties. No particles of metal, cured resin flash, dirt or synthetic materials which cause imperfections in the molded tray will be permitted.

3.6 Resistance to boiling water. Trays shall show no cracks, chalking, changes of color, or any other defects impairing serviceability or appearance. Trays shall not warp diagonally more than 0.093 inch when tested as specified in 4.3.1.

3.7 Resistance to boiling sulfuric acid solution. Test specimens cut from the trays shall show no chalking when tested as specified in 4.3.2.

3.8 Warpage. Warpage of trays shall be not greater than 0.0625 inch when measured as specified in 4.3.3 and 4.3.3.1.

3.9 Resistance to dry heat. Trays shall show no cracks, color change, or blisters when tested as specified in 4.3.4.

3.10 Stacking lugs. Trays shall have a minimum of four stacking lugs (one at each corner) molded integral with the tray.

3.11 Marking for identification. The trays shall be marked in a plain and permanent manner with the manufacturer's name or with a trademark of such known character that the source of manufacture may be determined.

3.12 Workmanship. The finished trays shall be clean, well made and free from any defects which may affect appearance or serviceability.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any other commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling for inspection and acceptance. Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.2.1 Inspection of components and material. In accordance with 4.1, the supplier is responsible for insuring that components and materials used are manufactured and inspected in accordance with the specified requirements of referenced subsidiary specifications and standards, or if none, in accordance with this specification.

4.2.2 End product inspection. The inspection lot shall consist of all items of one type offered for inspection at the same time. The sample unit shall be one completely finished tray.

4.2.2.1 Visual examination. Examination of the end item shall be in accordance with the classification of defects in table I. The inspection level shall be II with acceptable quality levels (AQL's) of 2.5 for major defects and 6.5 for total defects, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

Table I. Classification of defects, end item

Examine	Defects	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Trays	Scuffed or abraded area	X	
	Scratch		X
	Dent	X	
	Crack or fracture	X	
	Chalking	X	
	Pinhole	X	
	Blister	X	
	Wrinkle	X	
	Pit	X	
	Flow mark	X	
	Shrinkage	X	
	Unfilled area	X	
	Chipped	X	
	Presence of mechanical oil or grease dirt, wood shavings, metal chips, or foreign matter	X	
Luster	Lacks luster (dull)	X	
	Not uniform high luster throughout		X
Color	Not specified color	X	
	Lack of uniformity of color		X
Finish	Presence of any finishing coating	X	
	Lack of uniformity of finish		X
Construction and design			
Design	Varies from design and shape shown on drawing	X	
Material	Not plastic	X	
	Presence of metal, cured resin, flash, dirt, or synthetic materials	X	
Corners and edges	Sharp	X	
	Not broken and polished		X
Surfaces and curves	Not blended smoothly		X

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Table I. Classification of defects, end item (continued)

Examine	Defects	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Flashline	Not machined or burnished		X
	Insufficiently ground and burnished		X
Stacking feature	Stacking lugs missing	X	
	Out of position	X	
	Trays fail to stack firmly and evenly	X	
	Poor nesting	X	
Identification marking	Not permanently marked		X
	Missing or incorrect		X
	Illegible		X

4.2.2.2 Dimensional examination. Inspection shall be made of trays for conformance with dimensions specified herein. Any nonconformance with specified requirements shall be classified a defect. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

4.2.2.3 End product testing. Testing shall be performed on tray samples from each inspection lot in accordance with 4.3.1 through 4.3.4, inclusive. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

4.2.3 Inspection of preparation for delivery requirements. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packing and marking requirements comply with section 5. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table II. For examination of contents the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery selected just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

Table II. Classification of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Bulging or distortion of container.

4.3 Tests.

4.3.1 Resistance to boiling water. Each sample shall be immersed by suspending for 30 minutes in boiling water, removed and allowed to stand for 1 hour at room temperature. This cycle shall be immediately repeated three times for a total of four such cycles. The sample shall then be allowed to stand overnight in air at normal room temperature before examination. Diagonal warpage shall be determined by placing the tray upright (position of normal use on the table) on a flat surface. If diagonal corners are found not touching the flat surface, either raised corner shall be held down by hand so that three corners are touching. In this position the clearance between the raised corner of the tray and flat surface shall be such that a "feeler" gage of the specified maximum thickness cannot be inserted (see 3.6).

4.3.2 Resistance to boiling sulfuric acid. Tray test specimens shall be prepared by cutting the tray into four equal quarters. All the quarters shall be used in the test. Specimen shall be immersed by suspending for 10 minutes in boiling 0.8 percent (by weight) sulfuric acid, then rinsed in cold water and dried. The examination shall not include any area 1/4 inch or less from any cut (not molded) edge (see 3.7).

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4.3.3 Warpage. Rim warpage shall be determined by placing the tray upside down on a flat surface and holding firmly in place by a 10 pound weight, with a diameter not to exceed 5 inches, positioned at the center of the tray. In this position the tray shall be sufficiently plane so that a "feeler" gage of the specified maximum thickness (0.0625 inch) cannot be inserted at any point between the tray and the flat surface (see 3.8).

4.3.3.1 For warpage (other than rim). Trays shall be placed upright (position of normal use on the table) on a flat surface and loaded with a 10 pound weight as specified in 4.3.3. In this position the tray shall be sufficiently plane so that a "feeler" gage of the maximum thickness (0.0625 inch) cannot be inserted at any point between the tray and the flat surface (see 3.8).

4.3.4 Resistance to dry heat. Place the tray in a circulating air oven for 8 hours at 170°F. The specimen shall then be removed, placed in the position of use on a table and allowed to cool normally to room temperature before examination (see 3.9).

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Twevle trays of like description shall be nested with paper separators conforming to UU-P-553 between each tray. The trays shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, W5c. The box shall be closed, waterproofed, sealed and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.2 Level B. Twelve trays of like description shall be nested with paper separators conforming to UU-P-553 between each tray. The trays shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, type CF, class-domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.3 Level C. The trays shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination in containers at the lowest rates complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.2 Standard packaging (civil agencies). The standard packaging and packing for civil agencies shall be as specified in 5.1.2.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The trays are intended for use in schools, hospitals, and cafeterias.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

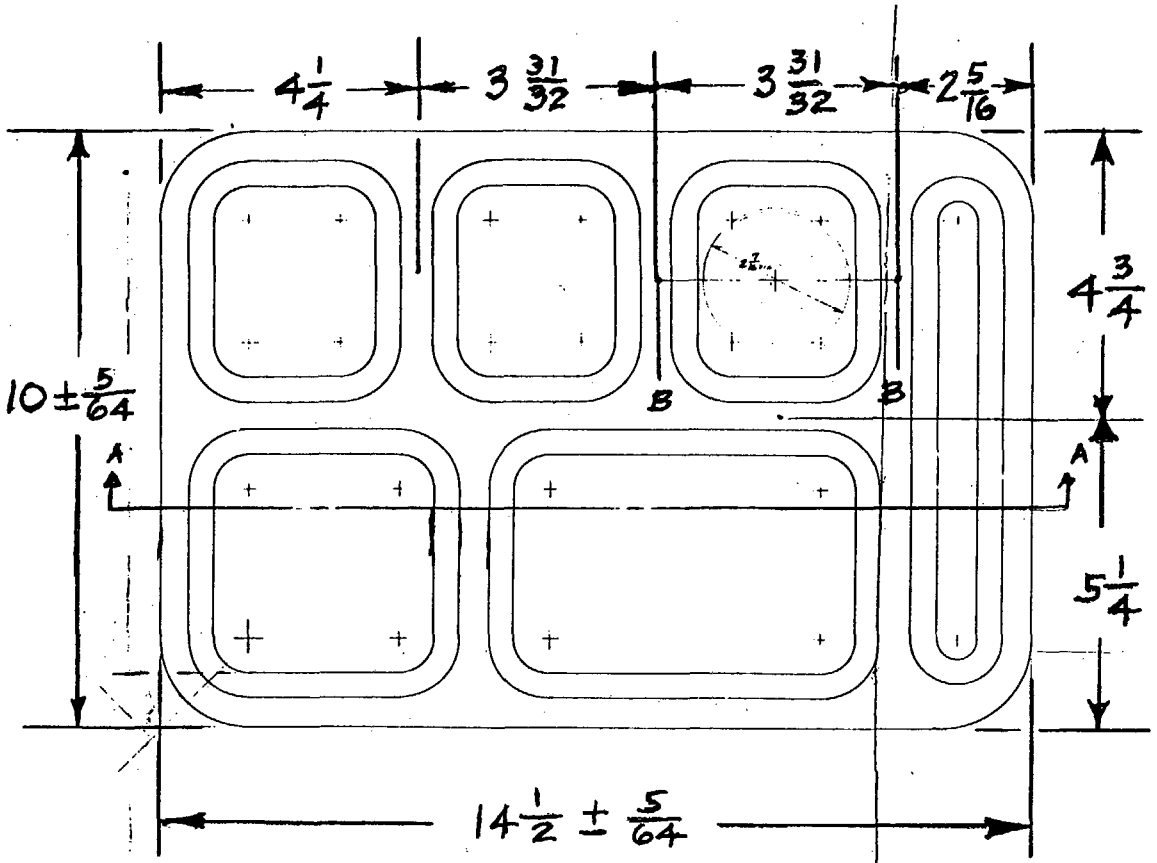
(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type of tray required (see 1.2).
(c) Contractor certificate of compliance with L-M-181, type I material (see 3.1).
(d) Contractor certificate of compliance with FDA material for contact with food (see 3.1.1).
(e) Selection of applicable level of packing required (see 5.1).

Preparing activity:

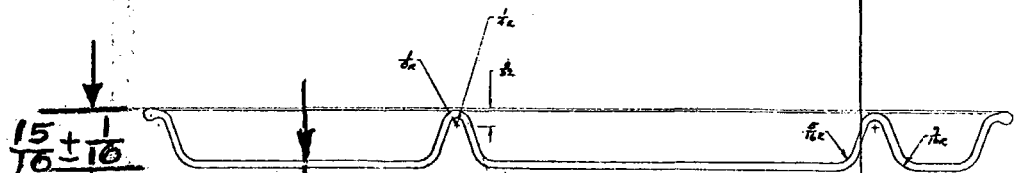
GSA-FSS

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies of documents referenced herein. Price 5 cents each.

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DIMENSIONS SHOWN ON THIS DRAWING ARE IN INCHES UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED, FABRICATING TOLERANCES ARE: DECIMALS ± 0.020 INCH, FRACTIONS ± 1/16 INCH.



SEC. A-A

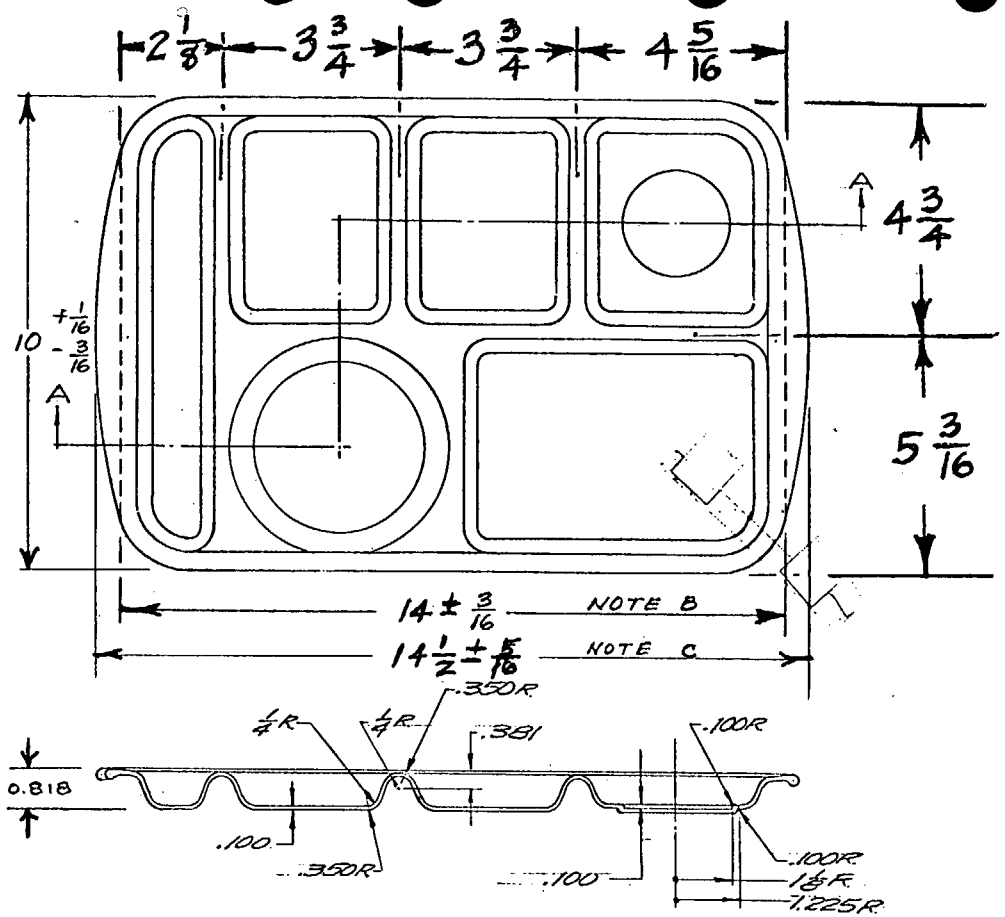


SEC. B-B

TYPE I TRAY MESS COMPARTMENTED 10 INCH BY 14½ INCH

FIGURE I

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NOTE B DIMENSION APPLIES TO STRAIGHT END DESIGN
NOTE C DIMENSION APPLIES TO CURVED END DESIGN
BOTH DESIGNS ARE ACCEPTABLE

SEC. A-A

DIMENSIONS SHOWN IN INCHES.

UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED, FABRICATING TOLERANCES ARE: DECIMALS, ±.020 INCH; FRACTIONS, ±1/16 INCH

TYPE II
TRAY, MESS, COMPARTMENTED
FIGURE 2

MIL-T-7786

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